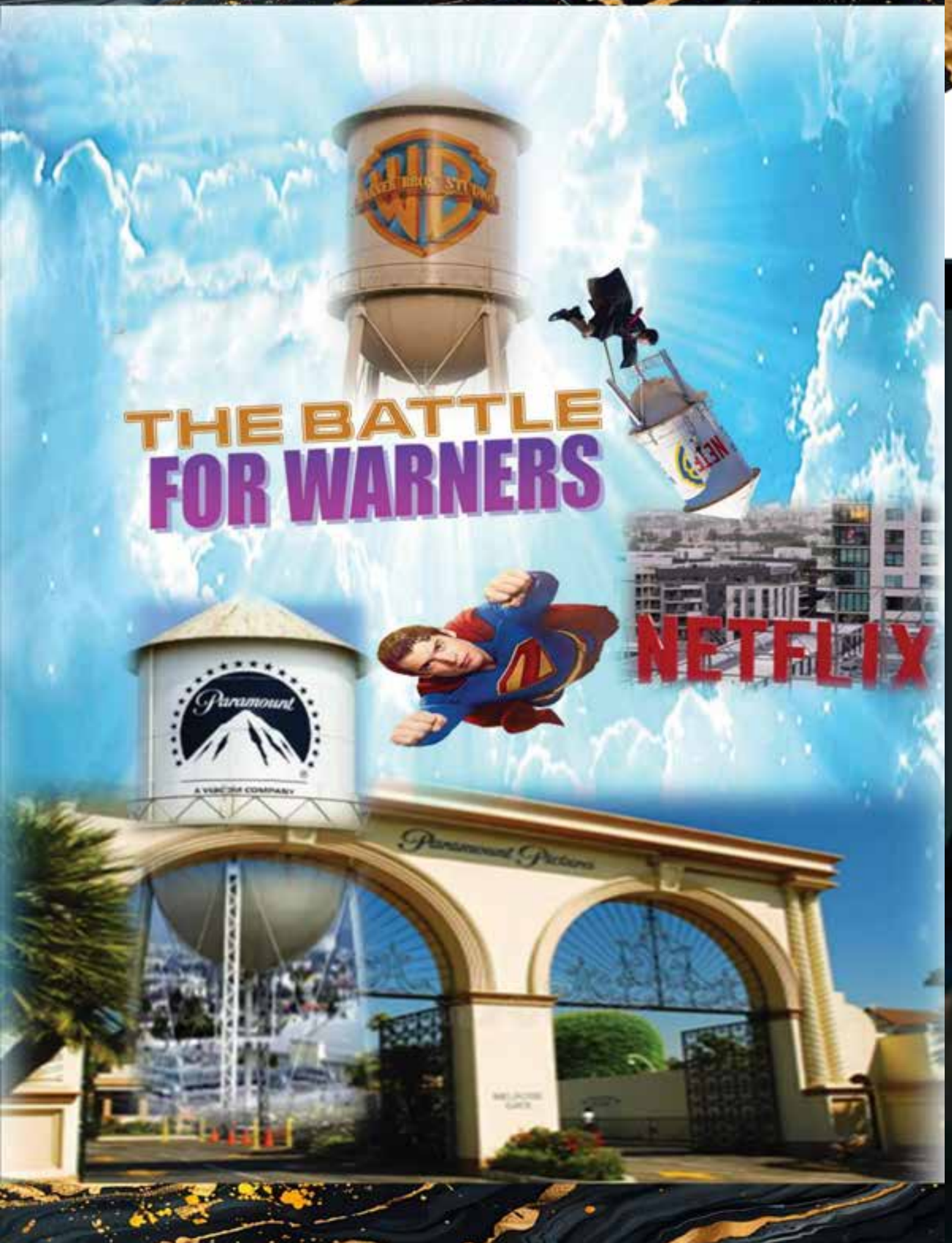
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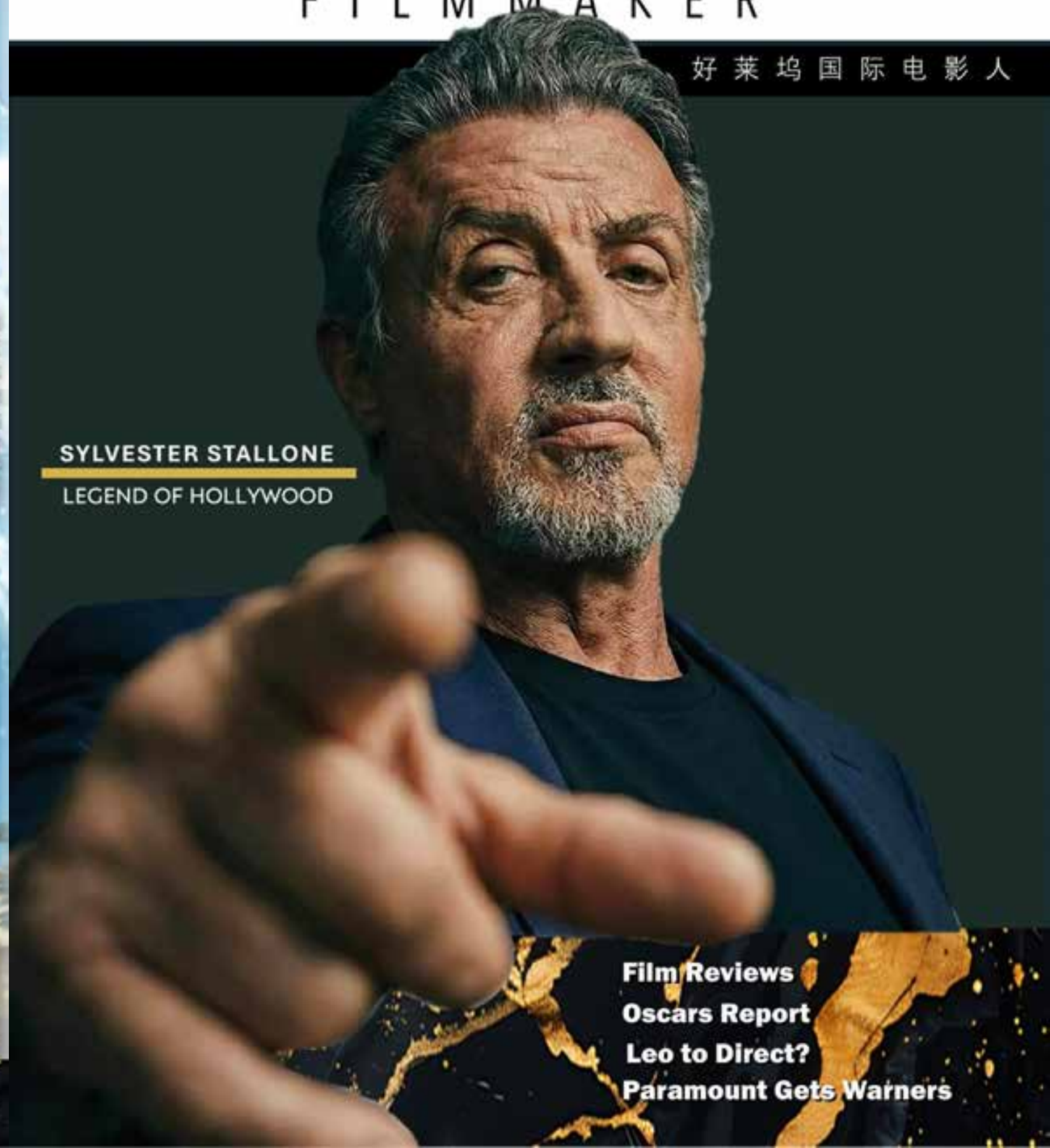
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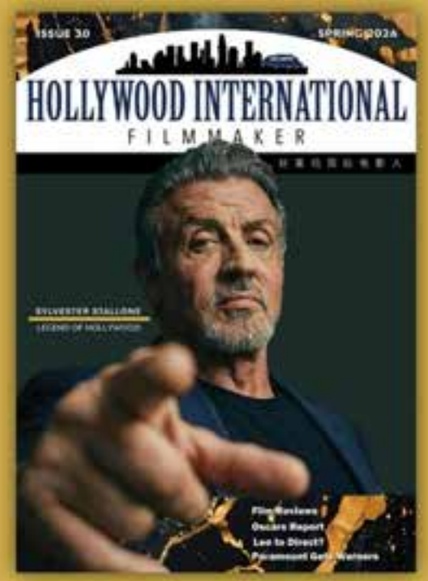
SYLVESTER STALLONE

LEGEND OF HOLLYWOOD

Film Reviews
Oscars Report
Leo to Direct?
Paramount Gets Warners

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The Breakthrough



The Action Icon



The Capo



SYLVESTER STALLONE: Still Punching

Fifty years on from the release of his breakthrough film Rocky. Sylvester Stallone remains a knockout screen icon.

And despite being well established among the most successful stars in Hollywood history, he's got no thoughts of slowing down or retiring, only to keep moving forward.

Sly says: "I question myself: how much is enough? When do you stop trying to prove yourself? The answer is never!"

The 79-year-old cinema legend adds: "Physically you are going to fall apart but the mind is a muscle that keeps going."

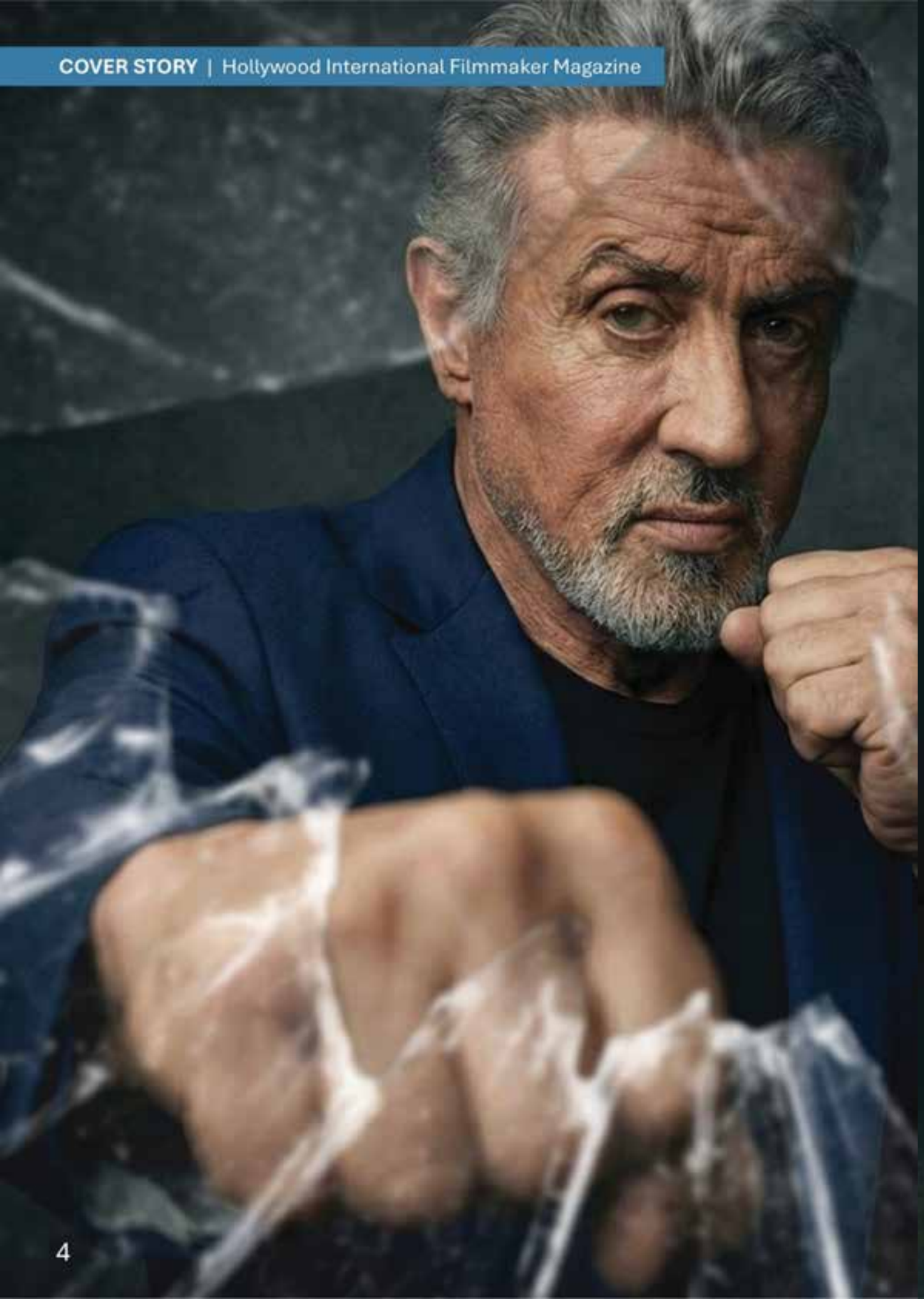
And the latest project he turned that creative mind to is gangster drama Tulsa King, a streaming series now in its third season and a huge hit around the world, proving many of the doubters wrong.

"People were asking 'Why is Stallone doing TV?' Everyone was sceptical. I love that. But it worked and I had a feeling it would."

A key element in the show's success, according to Stallone, is that it exists to entertain, not moralize. He explains: "It's the post office's job to send messages, that's not the role of storytellers."

That understanding of what the audience wants is evident over the next few pages as we look back at some of his famous movies, from Rocky to Rambo, Cliffhanger to Cobra, The Expendables and so many others, his continues to be an incredibly, impactful career.

SANDRO MONETTI



















"It's the post office's job to send messages, that's not the role of storytellers."

Sylvester Stallone



LEO SAYS NO TO DIRECTING

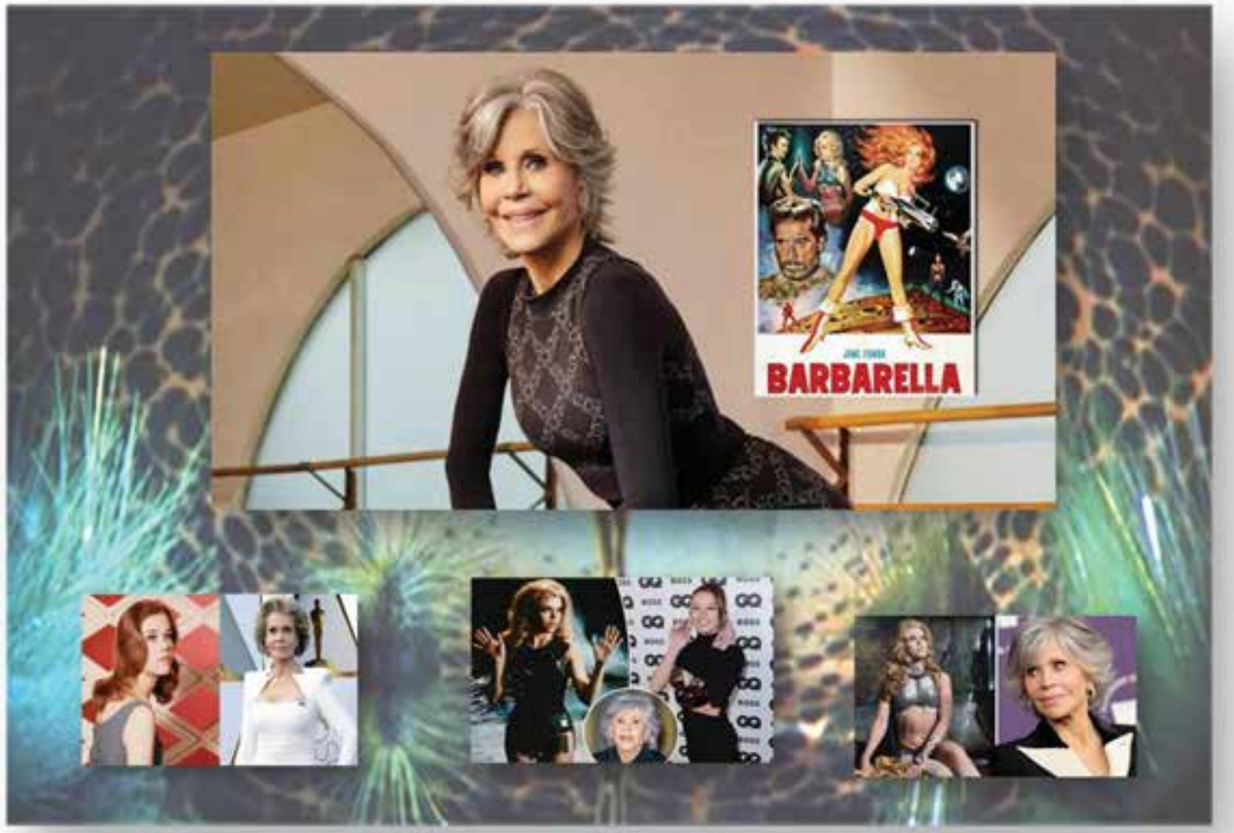
Despite all his experience in film, Leonardo Di Caprio is not interested in ever directing a movie.

He explains there is no point because he could not match the prowess of directing great Martin Scorsese.

Leo said: "I would never Want to direct. I could never do anything close to what Martin Scorsese does. Why would I do that?"

He has worked with Scorsese on six previous films, including The Departed and The Wolf of Wall Street, and they are now at work on their seventh collaboration, What Happens at Night, with DiCaprio starring alongside Jennifer Lawrence.

SANDRO MONETTI



A DISH CALLED FONDA:
Jane's Barbarella Remake Message

Original Barbarella star Jane Fonda says she has "a lot of ideas" about a planned remake of the sexy space film but adds, "Nobody's asked me about it."

A new version of the 1968 film has been in development with Sydney Sweeney attached to star and Edgar Wright to direct.

Jane Fonda is not connected to the new production but wishes it "good luck" and has expressed support for Sweeney's casting saying: "I think she's great and I'm sure she'll be a fantastic Barbarella."

The original film, directed by Fonda's then husband Roger Vadim, has become widely considered as a camp classic with imagery that has echoed in popular culture for years.

SANDRO MONETTI



NEWS

FROM SINNERS TO SAVIORS

Michael B Jordan says the huge success of his film Sinners sends a message to the movie industry.

With a US gross of $279 million, the horror drama was the most successful original film of 2025 not based on an existing story, brand or IP.

The film's star said: "The success of Sinners proves audiences are ready for original content and that's a great reassurance to our industry.

"To see the amount of people who came out to the theater to see it, not just once but two, three, four or five times shows we were doing something right.

"Hopefully this encourages other filmmakers to take a big swing.

"Write what you know, build worlds you can see clearly and, if you've got the goods, people will come."

Sinners was written and directed by Jordan's longtime collaborator, Ryan Coogler, whose previous hits include Black Panther and Creed.

■ SANDRO MONETTI



NEWS

THE POPE'S PEP TALK TO TINSELTOWN

The Pope has issued a message of hope to Hollywood.

Pope Leo, who is a big film fan, welcomed moviemakers including Spike Lee, Greta Gerwig, Cate Blanchett and Viggo Mortensen to the Vatican and used the occasion to give a stirring speech about the importance of films in the human experience.

He urged his audience to cherish movie theaters as vital places that are "the beating hearts of our communities."

And he urged filmmakers to create art that challenges, consoles and articulates human questions and encouraged them to tell difficult stories and include the voices of marginalized people.

The American pontiff recently named his four favorite movies as The Sound of Music, It's a Wonderful Life, Ordinary People and Life is Beautiful, all of which he says convey important values like hope, family and dignity.

■ SANDRO MONETTI

CAPSTONE GROUP

COMING SOON

At the world's most glamorous and significant movie market, the Cannes Film Festival, a batch of exciting new films were unveiled to international buyers.

ABOVE & BELOW

In this action thriller starring Antonia Banderas, friends embark on a dream vacation of parties and diving only for their fun trip to take a terrifying turn when criminals attack them at sea. Also starring Laura Marano, the film is directed by Jesse V. Johnson.











AMI

A sci-fi survival thriller which sees Mads Mikkelsen star as an astronaut who crash-lands on an uncharted planet after a catastrophic accident with only his Quantum AI companion Ami (Diane Kruger) left to aid in his escape. Fernando Szurman directs.









Other titles coming soon from Capstone include supernatural mystery Black Box (Flight 298), animated film Slime featuring an all-star voice cast and horror film Obsession.

Write & Edited by Sandro Monetti
Designed by Jimmy Jiang

Arclight films

COMING SOON

At the world's most glamorous and significant movie market, the Cannes Film Festival, a batch of exciting new films were unveiled to international buyers.

MASERATI:
THE BROTHERS





Biographical sports drama chronicling the rise of Italy's legendary Maserati family and their pursuit of automotive excellence. It's the story of four brothers chasing their dream of building the fastest race car in the world and immortalizing their name in legend.



SCORPION



Thriller starring Aaron Eckhart as a CIA black-ops agent who becomes the fall guy for a failed mission and goes I nto hiding. Finding enemies on all sides, he must fight to protect his daughter and exact revenge on the intelligence director who set him up.

TIMUR





High-ocatane action thriller based on a real life hostage crisis. A soldier named Timur leads a rescue team on a dangerous mission to free researchers kidnapped in the jungle. Trapped in a fraught area, they must face extreme terrain, time pressure, and unexpected dangers. Iko Uwais both stars in and directs the film.



One Battle After Another was the big winner at the 98th Academy Awards winning six trophies, including Best Picture, and there was a strong showing too by Sinners, winning four, including best actor for Michael B Jordan. Jessie Buckley won best actress for Hamnet.











SHOWING THE LOVE TO CASTING DIRECTORS

The Academy Awards this year introduced a new category for the first time in a quarter of a century, adding an Oscar for Achievement in Casting.

And casting directors say the honor that puts their profession on a par with other key disciplines in filmmaking is welcome, if long overdue.

"I am thrilled," said Jane Jenkins, whose casting credits include When Harry Met Sally, The Princess Bride, Ferris Bueller's Day Off and Casino Royale.

"Since the inception of the Casting Society of America in 1982 we have worked for the recognition of the contribution the casting director makes. It's taken 44 years but at long last we have arrived."

Echoing that opinion was Joseph D'Agosta, who cast the original Star Trek TV series before becoming a casting executive at Universal, Paramount and Warner Bros.

He added: "All working actors - no exception - get their early and sometimes career long opportunities because the casting director gave them the opportunities to be invited into the producer and director's offices."

Three weeks before the Oscars, Jane and Joseph (pictured) showed a different side to their talents when they acted together in director Gloria Gifford's superb Los Angeles stage production of romantic play, Love Letters. Maybe an acting Oscar as well as a casting one is in their future!

The nominees for this year's first ever casting Oscar were Nina Gold (*Hamnet*), Jennifer Venditti (*Marty Supreme*), Cassandra Kulukundis (*One Battle After Another*), Gabriel Domingues (*The Secret Agent*), and Francine Maisler (*Sinners*).

The Academy will add a further new category in 2028, awarding an Oscar for best stunt design.

Sandro Monetti

Shaping Fashion's Future

AWARDS | Hollywood International Filmmaker Magazine

Designers and models from around the world made IFSM Fashion Week in Los Angeles a showcase of innovation and creativity.







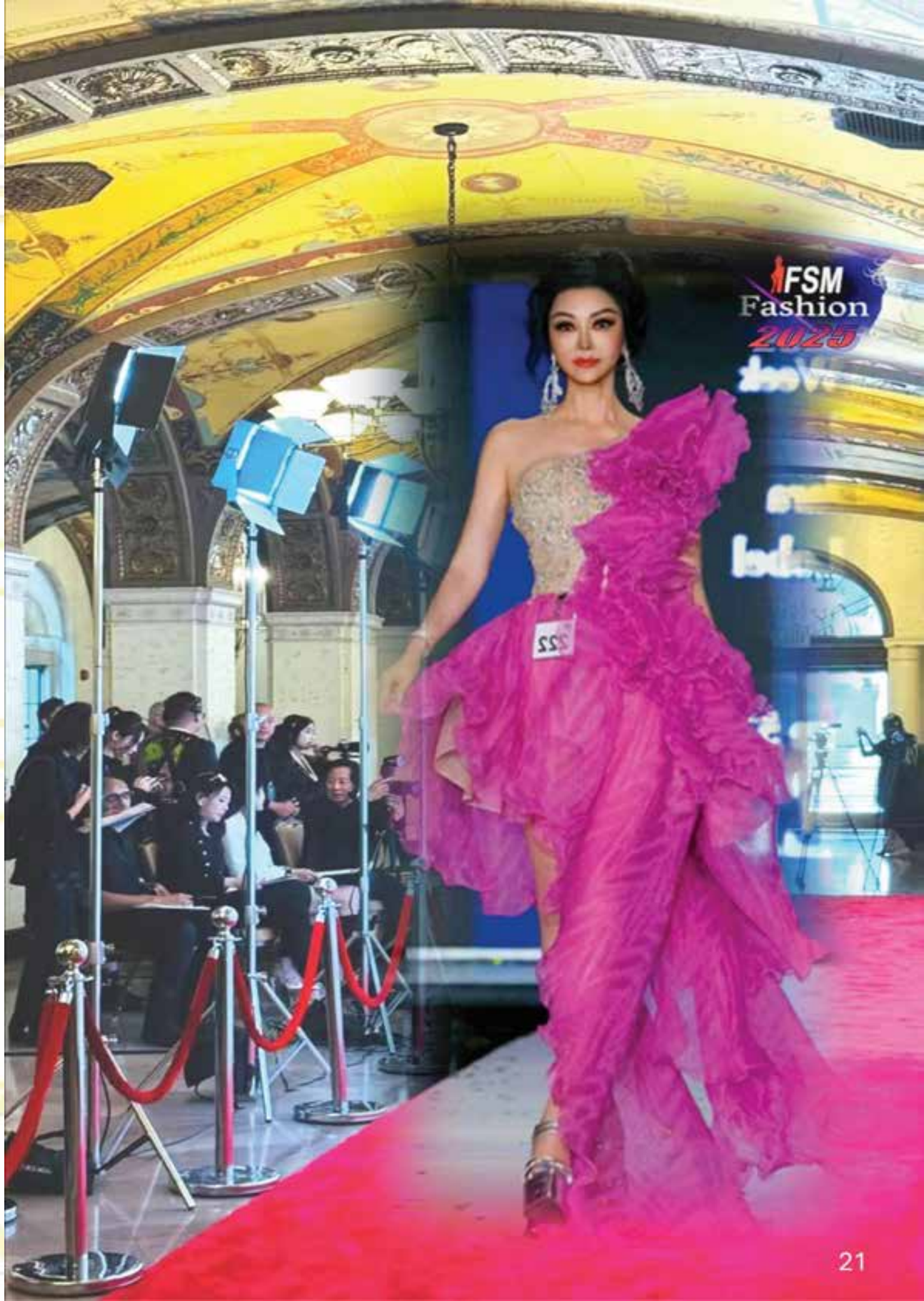






At its centerpiece was the International Fashion Supermodel Competition featuring dynamic runway presentations and future modeling stars,
IFSM's Michelle Li said: "Our mission is to broaden global fashion dialogue, strengthen cultural exchange, and provide a platform where creativity from around the world can flourish."

It was a mission accomplished as the event at the historic Millennium Biltmore Hotel brought together top fashion talents in a celebration of diversity and originality.



CELEBRATION OF AAPI CINEMA & TELEVISION

THE IMPACT *of Inclusion*

Actors, advocates and industry leaders gathered in Los Angeles to spotlight the expanding impact of Asian Americans and Pacific Islanders in Hollywood. Organized by the Critics' Choice Association, the Celebration of AAPI Cinema & Television rewarded creatives reshaping the cultural landscape.



Among the honorees were Hamnet's Chloe Zhao, honored with the Vanguard award for her visionary directing style, actress Lucy Lui who was presented with the Trailblazer award by Dwayne Johnson for her groundbreaking career and Hikari who received the Director award from her Rental Family star Brendan Fraser.







The inspirational ceremony emphasized the importance of expanding AAPI inclusion across all levels of storytelling.





SANDRO AND THE STARS

Sandro Monetti is the man the stars talk to. Here's our magazine's editor-in-chief pictured with some of his Hollywood favorites.







We asked these famous Hollywood names about the movies they loved growing up and which put them on the path to their own screen careers...



THE MOVIE

Jenifer Lopez
The first movie that really impacted my life was West Side Story because there were Puerto Ricans in it, and I had not really seen that in anything else. And I just love the Romeo and Juliet story that it's based on, obviously. It was just a love story and a musical.
It had everything I needed as a little girl and wanted. And I could see myself in it. And I think that representation was important for me. I wouldn't be doing what I'm doing today if it wasn't for that movie.



Spike Lee
My mother took me to see the James Bond film, Goldfinger, and I remember loudly asking my mother about one the characters" "Why is that lady's name Pussy Galore?" Well, everybody in the theatre heard what I said and my mother was so embarrassed I almost got choked to death. I was like "What did I say?"
But I loved so much about that film, from the ejector seat to the Shirely Bassey theme song, and I grew up loving Sean Connery and 007.

THAT



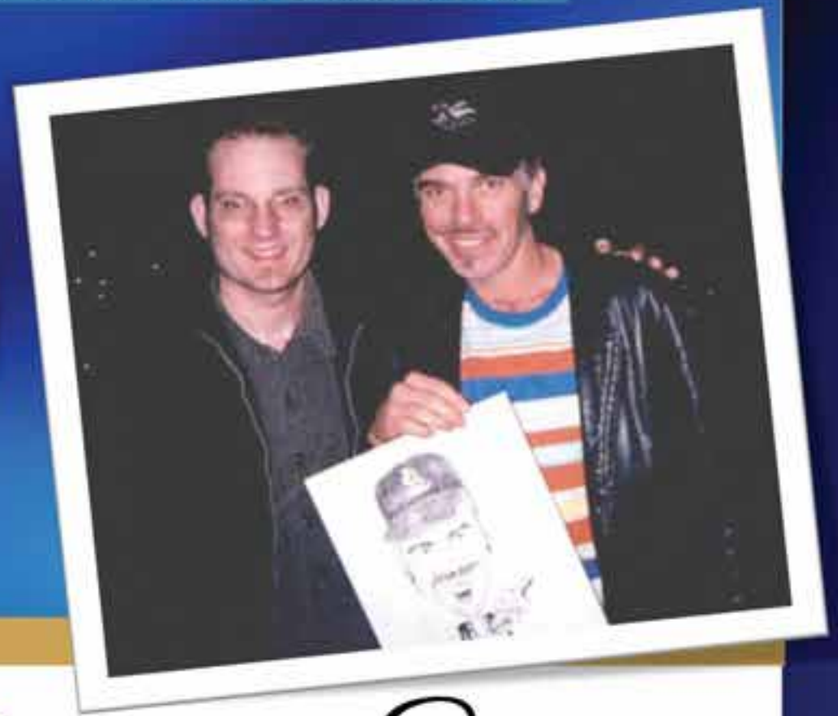
Brett Goldstein
Sure, Citizen Kane and The Godfather are good films but The Muppet Christmas Carol is the greatest film ever made. I love The Muppets and Brian Henson who directed that masterpiece is my hero. I got to work with him on my stand up special, The Second Best Night of Your Life.
Incidentally, the best day of my life , as I mention in that special, was when I made a guest appearance with the Muppets on Sesame Street. The problem is you have to continue living afterwards and you're like what's the point after that?

SHAPED ME

SANDRO MONETTI

Jennifer's latest film is Kiss of the Spider Woman, Spike's is Highest 2 Lowest and Brett's is All Of You





Drawing the Stars

Caricaturist Todd Tuttle has a gift for capturing Hollywood's most famous faces – as these examples of his work prove.

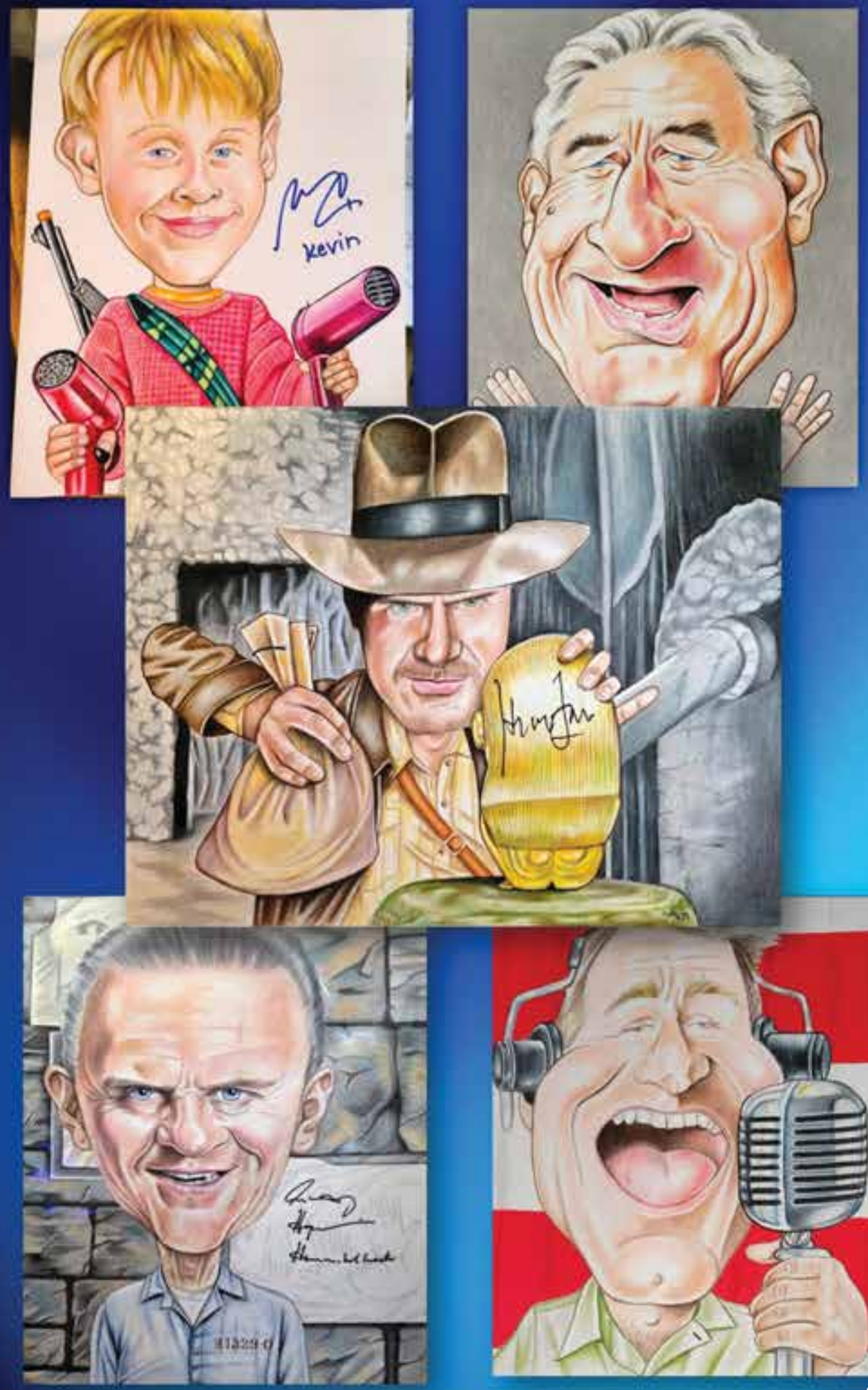
The stars themselves are fans of his drawings with Leonardo DiCaprio, Billy Bob Thornton and Austin Butler among the big names who have praised his talent.

Encouraged by his art teacher, Todd started drawing caricatures for his school paper and yearbook and by the age of 14 he already was the cartoonist for his local newspaper.

A love of movies later saw him specialize in caricatures of actors and he will often gift the drawings to his favorite stars or get them to autograph the sketches.

Hollywood International Filmmaker magazine is honored to showcase his work.

Sandro Monetti



THEY DON'T MAKE THEM

LIKE THAT ANY MORE...

In case you haven't noticed, movies just don't look like they used to...

And it's not CGI, AI or filters to blame for films looking more like selfies or video games.

The new standard is for modern moviemakers to use much wider lenses – so you get ultra wide field of views. Everything used to be shot at a distance but these wider lenses pull the action much closer so the camera is in the scene with the actors.

Plus the older movies were shot at eye level whereas now you have cameras floating around on drones to create a less natural viewpoint.

As an example, consider the original Jurassic Park in 1994. The dinosaurs were mostly seen from our eye level. But in 2025's Jurassic World Rebirth you would have cameras at the dinosaur's ears.

Another big difference with the digital filming techniques used now is that actors never look sweaty or dirty like they sometimes used to – instead they are presented always looking at their best and that semes to some less authentic.

The point here is not that the different moviemaking techniques are wrong – the immersive look may well be much more suited to modern audiences who grew up on social media posts and gaming. Things just aren't as cinematic as they used to be.

Sandro Monetti



THE *Intimacy* COORDINATOR









Intimacy coordinators have become a welcome new addition to the movie world by helping make film sets a safe space.

But what if one of them was abusing that position of trust by secretly being a sex addict?

That's the premise of a bold and daring new short film called The Intimacy Coordinator.

The thought-provoking drama shows the character spiraling out of control as she struggles to hide her desires and stick to her boundaries.

Playing the lead role, and also writing and directing, is fast rising star Louisa Connolly-Burnham, whose previous provocative short film, Sister Wives, was a multi-award winner which qualified for both the Oscars and BAFTAs.

This film, co-starring Kieran Moore and Sophie Simnett, is also being positioned for an award run and already earning great buzz.

SANDRO MONETTI

THE BEST FILM MAGAZINE IN THE WORLD

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FIRST TIME PLUCKY



Movie star Kate Winslet stepped behind the camera for the first time to direct new family drama Goodbye June – and she wasn't the only novice filmmaker on set.

"It was important to me to me to bring other first timers onto the film as I love to lift people up," she said.

"So we had a lot of first time department heads, a first time costume designer, a first time production designer, a first time composer and a first time writer."

That writer was her own son, 21-year-old Joe Anders, who based the script on the death of his grandmother.

Kate added: "His tutor said 'write what you know' so he took his memories of the family coming together when my mum passed away and got a story out of it. As soon as I read it I said to him we should make this into a film. Later I said I feel I can direct it too."

Winslet is thrilled with her decision to direct the personal story herself. "It was an amazing experience and I loved every minute of it."



KLINGON TO YOUR SEATS:

GIAMATTI JOINS STAR TREK









STARFLEET ACADEMY

Following up his best actor Oscar nomination for The Holdovers with a TV role as a space pirate in the new Star Trek series was a no-brainer for Paul Giamatti.

That's because he's been a fan of the huge fan of the space franchise ever since he was a kid.

"I love Star Trek, it made a big impression on me as a child and gave me a sense of wonder," said Paul, who considers his villainous role as half-Klingon Nus Braka in Starfleet Academy a dream role. "It's about both the human element and the fantastical.

"Plus it keeps you young. I'm almost 60 and appreciate a show full of youthful energy, new ideas and perspectives. Starfleet Academy I s a show literally about young people embarking on an adventure."

And although he's never met a space alien, the actor doesn't rule out the possibility, adding: "I haven't ever seen a UFO but I do believe there is a extra terrestrial life. It seems crazy that there isn't some other life form out there."





By Sandro Monetti

STAR TREK AT 60: UP UP AND TAKEI





Star Trek is celebrating its 60th anniversary this year and original cast member George Takei knows why the space saga has endured so long.

The Sulu star says: "We have lived long and prospered because of the fans and the vision of the series creator Gene Roddenberry.

"His commitment to diversity showed a positive future where humanity has overcome its differences."

Takei was speaking in Los Angeles at a special screening of Star Trek IV: The Voyage Home, one of six Trek movies he starred in after the original series went off the air.

Sandro Monetti

bff

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AUTHENTICITY WAS EVERYTHING

Having won seven world drivers championships, you might think there were few thrills left for Formula One superstar Lewis Hamilton.

But the chance to be a producer on blockbuster movie F1 and make it the most realistic racing movie ever seen proved a real career highlight for the British sporting legend.



"It was a big responsibility but I jumped at the opportunity and it proved the most unbelievable experience," said Lewis.

His role was to ensure authenticity by contributing technical knowledge as an advisor on details like gear usage and G-forces and racing culture. He also gave actors Brad Pitt and Damson Indris insight into the motivations and mental and physical demands of F1 drivers.

Brad Pitt said: "Lewis was the perfect guard rails we had to tell this story and keep it legit and honest."

Hamilton added: "Authenticity was so important to me. Previous racing movies didn't quite capture the speed part but the technology used in this was at another level with these special cameras and tech you really feel what it's like to be a racing driver.

"I was shaking when I first watched the film with the other drivers but their reaction was amazing, as has been that of audiences right around the world."







REBORN IN THE USA

As if it wasn't enough of a challenge to play Bruce Springsteen in a new biopic, actor Jeremy Allen White also had to deal with the rock star frequently being on the set to watch his performance.
Springsteen was heavily involved in the making of Deliver Me From Nowhere to ensure accuracy but liked all that he saw.
The superstar said: "Jeremy was very generous to me. Not only has he got the pressure of playing me, he's also got to deal with me sitting there on the other side of the camera."
But the acclaimed actor was always pleased to see him and said: "I was really excited to have Bruce around as a guide but also a little bit intimidated. I was very head down and trying to do justice to the story and to Bruce.
"At the end of many days, Bruce would send a message about a particular moment he felt was honest and that carried me so much. It was so wonderful to have Bruce's support of me."

Sandro Monetti





> "I was really excited to have Bruce around as a guide but also a little bit intimidated.



STANDING SMALL



Plenty of actors have had to lose or gain weight for a part but the challenge for Ethan Hawke in latest movie Blue Moon was to shrink by a foot in height!

Instead of resorting to computer generated effects, every classic movie making trick in the book was used to make Hawke convincing as five-foot-tall Broadway lyricist Lorenz Hart.

The actor said: "If you think of a trick we did it – from raising pictures behind me to building trenches for me to stand in. Buster Keaton and Charlie Chaplin knew how to achieve this back in the 1920s, it was doable with no computer tricks. This was all real and a lot of people helped me."

Hawke has received some of the best reviews of his storied career for Blue Moon, a drama about the legendary composing team Rogers and Hart.

Sandro Monetti

Project

THE SOUNDTRACK OF HER LIFE

INTERVIEWS | HIFM

THE Soundtrack OF HER Life

SANDRO MONETTI

Metadats

Diane Warren has written some of the best movie songs of all time but her latest one likely meant more to her than all the rest.
That's because the song, Dear Me, from the documentary about the 16-time Oscar nominee's life, Relentless, is about herself.
"It's my most personal song," she explained. "Written to the wounded child in me.
"I had a hard childhood. I felt really lonely and I was bullied. I wanted to give that little girl a hug and say it's all going to be ok.
"But I think it's also a universal song as we all have a wounded child inside of us."
Kesha performs the song in the documentary, which follows Diane's rise to becoming one of the most successful song writers of all time with 33 top ten hits and nine number one singles.
Her compositions for films have included I Don't Want To Miss a Thing (Armageddon), Nothing's Gonna Stop Us Now (Mannequin), Because You Loved Me (Up Close and Personal) and How Do I Live (Con Air).

Program Monitor



Timeline

00:00 00:01:82:00 00:01:21:00 00:02:02:00 00:02:23:00 00:02:12:00 00:23:20:00 00:22:30:00 00:22:30:00 00:22:02:00 00:23:12:00 00:23:40:00 00:02:29:00 00:32:26:00 00:32:06:00 00:32:

V1 Video

MANNEQUIN (Nothing's Gonna Stop Us Now) | ARMAGEDDON (I Don't Wanna Miss a Thing) | CON AIR (How Do I Live) | UP CLOSE AND PERSONAL (Because You Loved Me) | RELENTLESS (Dear Me)

A1 Audio

DIANE WARREN (LIFE SCORE)

Audio

CON AIR (H

THE WONDERFUL WICKED OF OZ

The stars of Wicked: For Good each tell us they have been changed for good by the experience of filming the global blockbuster.



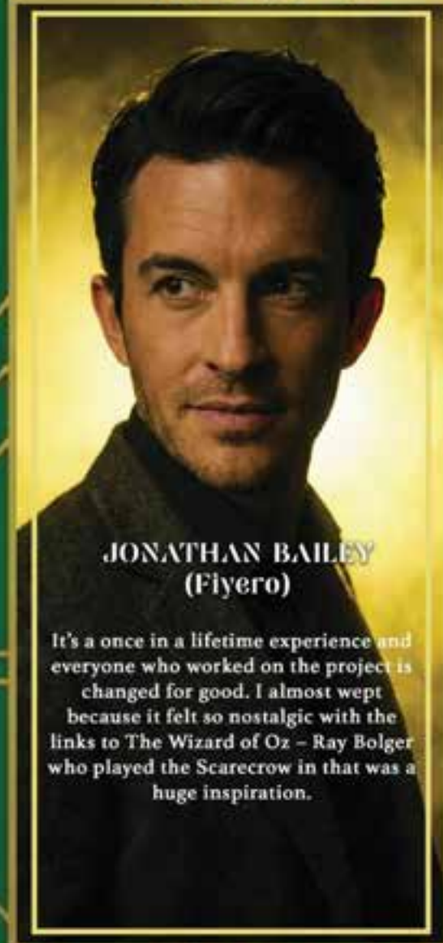
CYNTHIA ERIVO (Elphaba)

This has been the ride of a lifetime. To be part of something that moves people and changes the way they think about themselves and others is a privilege It taught me that the work you put in really does matter and it's reinvigorated my knowledge that I love my job. I knew from the beginning this would be a life changing project but I didn't know the gravity – please excuse the pun – of what it would be.



ARIANA GRANDE (Glinda)

All our Wicked fans are extraordinary. Their response to the films has been beautiful and overwhelming. I've loved Wicked my entire life so this was incredibly daunting for me but I love how this movie invites people to reconsider the labels of good and evil.



JONATHAN BAILEY (Fiyero)

It's a once in a lifetime experience and everyone who worked on the project is changed for good. I almost wept because it felt so nostalgic with the links to The Wizard of Oz – Ray Bolger who played the Scarecrow in that was a huge inspiration.



JON M CHU (Director)

Everyone coming into this was an underdog – Cynthia, Ariana and me. People thought musicals were dead and they thought cinema was dead. But look what happened. pun – of what it would be.



WHEN MUSIC LEARNS A NEW LANGUAGE

When a film crosses borders, it does more than change languages- it learns how to speak again.

Localization reshapes how a story feels, sounds, and resonates with new audiences, with music acting as the bridge between cultures and balancing fidelity with adaptation.

One such example is Hayao Miyazaki's animated film "Kiki's Delivery Service", which was released in Japan in 1989 and finally reached wide Western audiences through Disney's 1997 release.

In the Disney version, the original opening and ending songs were replaced, and the score was expanded to reinforce character identity and narrative momentum, creating a more continuous emotional flow.

Instrumentation also differs. The Japanese score relies primarily on orchestral writing, while the amended version incorporates electronic textures. Kiki's transformation was not an isolated case. It emerged from a broader shift in the 1990s, when Japanese animation entered a phase of cultural globalization in the United States.

Earlier titles such as Astro Boy, Speed Racer, and Robotech had introduced anime to American audiences, but cable television, home video, fan communities, and the digital revolution in scoring and dubbing reshaped how anime was distributed and experienced. Anime was no longer simply imported—it was reintroduced.

English dubs of series like Pokémon and Dragon Ball Z reveal this shift, alongside new collaborations between Japanese studios and American distributors.

Studio Ghibli's films, including Castle in the Sky and My Neighbor Totoro, underwent multiple English-language adaptations.

Listening to Kiki's Delivery Service across versions reveals only the tip of the iceberg in music localization.

Through these contrasts, we can hear clear differences in film-music approaches and stylistic tendencies between the two cultures.

But together, they serve to remind us that when music speaks carefully, every note finds a new way to resonate.

By Muye Yu





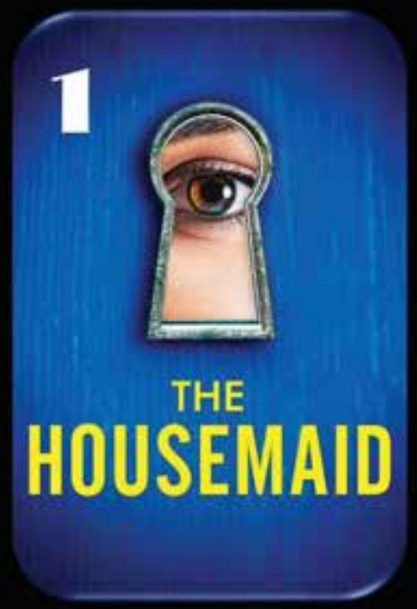




Sandro at the Cinema



The best films of 2026 so far as reviewed by Editor-in-chief Sandro Monetti



The Housemaid

Twists and turns galore in this joyously entertaining thriller that will keep you guessing throughout.
Sydney Sweeney's down on her luck character thinks her fortunes to have changed when she lands a job as the live-in maid for a wealthy housewife (Amanda Seyfried) and her husband (Brandon Sklenar).

But nothing is what it seems in her glossy new world and danger is everywhere. Paul Feig directs with typical panache.



Wuthering Heights

Sumptuous, sexy and special in every single scene, a truly epic romance helped by all the star power of Margot Robbie and Jacob Elordi as doomed lovers Cathy and Heathcliff.
Liberally adapted from the classic novel by Emily Bronte, this visually stunning film further establishes director Emerald Fennell as one of the most interesting directors working today.



Crime 101

A cool new cops and robbers classic with a stacked cast of talent, exciting heists, terrific car chases and plenty of tension.
Chis Hemsworth, Halle Berry and Mark Ruffallo are all on top form as, respectively, a thief, an insurance agent and a police detective, but Barry Keoghan steals the film as a manic, motorbike riding bad guy.
Directed with pace and flair by Bart Layton this has echoes of another great LA crime film, Heat.



Send Help

Stranded on a desert island as the only two survivors of a plane crash are a horrible boss and his underappreciated employee – but soon the power dynamics switch as her resourcefulness proves their best chance of survival.
Rachel McAdams and Dylan O'Brien are brilliant as the castaways while director Sam Raimi is back to his best here, mixing social commentary with comedy, thrills, horror and plenty of surprises.



Shelter

Jason Statham can always be relied upon for engaging action movies and he delivers again here as a reclusive ex-special forces agent forced out of hiding to protect an orphaned teenage girl.
With great support from co-star Bodhi Rae Breathnach and with director Ric Roman Waugh drawing on his own past a stuntman to bring real visceral energy to the fight scenes, this is far superior to most other shoot-em-ups.

How Paramount Won Warner Bros

In one of the biggest shake-ups in modern Hollywood, Paramount has struck a deal to acquire Warner Bros.

The headline hitting agreement brings together two of the film industry's oldest studios under a single corporate roof.

The deal – which values the combined company at a staggering $110 billion - ends a dramatic bidding war with Netflix, which had earlier reached its own agreement to purchase Warners.

But Paramount — backed financially by billionaire Larry Ellison — returned with a higher all-cash bid of $31 per share, persuading WB to switch sides.

Netflix was well compensated for walking away from the deal it had already negotiated when Paramount agreed to cover the $2.8 billion breakup fee that Warner Bros. Discovery owed the streamer for abandoning their earlier agreement.

In a pledge of expansion, Larry's son, David Ellison — expected to lead the merged studio — has vowed to keep theatrical filmmaking central to the business, promising about 30 films per year across the combined Paramount and Warner Bros. labels. The goal is to compete more aggressively with streaming platforms while maintaining a steady theatrical pipeline.

Still, the merger has been raising concerns across the industry. By combining two major studios the deal further concentrates power in a shrinking number of Hollywood companies.

Recent Hollywood history has shown that consolidation typically brings cost-cutting and layoffs, and industry observers predict thousands of jobs could eventually be affected as the companies integrate.

The transaction still faces regulatory scrutiny and is expected to take six to twelve months to close.

But if approved, the merger of two giants with many iconic and enduring franchises, would create one of the most powerful movie studios in Hollywood history - — a company big enough to shape not only which films get made, but how audiences see them.

Sandro Monetti

